

NEXALINK TELECOMMUNICATIONS

POLICY: CALL CONDUCT

Field	Value
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Department	Call Center Operations

1. Scope

Applies to all customer service agents on every inbound call. Compliance is mandatory for QA scoring. This document consolidates Call Handling (CS-POL-2025-01) and De-escalation (CS-POL-2025-05) into a single agent-tier operating model. There is one agent tier; every call is resolved by the receiving agent or by raising a back-office ticket from the agent’s seat.

2. Rules

Severity: CRITICAL = immediate violation. MAJOR = scored failure. MINOR = coaching trigger.

2.1 Call Opening

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-001	Agent must greet with: ‘Thank you for calling NexaLink Telecommunications Broadband and Support. My name is [Name]. Who do I have the pleasure of speaking with today?’	MAJOR
CS-RULE-002	Agent must state recording notification immediately after greeting if not played by IVR: ‘This call may be recorded for quality assurance and training purposes.’	CRITICAL
CS-RULE-003	Agent must acknowledge the customer’s stated reason before proceeding: ‘I understand you are calling regarding [issue]. I can certainly help you with that.’	MAJOR

2.2 Identity Verification

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-004	Agent must verify the customer using exactly 3 of the following 5 identifiers before accessing any account data: (1) Full account holder name, (2) Account number, (3) Security PIN, (4) Last 4 digits of payment method, (5) Last 4 of SSN/National ID where applicable.	CRITICAL
CS-RULE-005	No account data, billing information, plan details, or account changes may be disclosed or processed before successful 3-of-5 verification is confirmed.	CRITICAL
CS-RULE-006	Third-party callers must be listed as Authorized Users in the CRM. No changes may be made for unlisted third parties under any circumstances.	CRITICAL

2.3 Communication Standards

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-007	Agent must respond to any customer statement or question within 3 seconds. Dead air exceeding 5 seconds without verbal acknowledgment is a violation.	MINOR
CS-RULE-008	Agent must not interrupt the customer. Maximum of 2 interruptions per call is permitted only to redirect a wandering conversation. Zero interruptions is the standard.	MINOR
CS-RULE-009	During any silent task (e.g. running a line test), agent must re-engage within 10 seconds: 'I am still here with you; [task] is in progress. Thank you for your patience.'	MINOR
CS-RULE-010	Agent talk ratio must not exceed 40% of total call duration. Agents must not deliver unbroken technical monologues.	MINOR

2.4 De-escalation

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-011	When a customer is angry or frustrated, agent must apply A.C.E.S. in order: Acknowledge → Clarify → Empathize → Solve. Skipping Acknowledge or jumping directly to Solve is a violation.	MAJOR
CS-RULE-012	The following phrases are forbidden in any customer interaction: ‘Calm down’ / ‘There is nothing I can do’ / ‘That is our policy’ / ‘I do not know’ / ‘That is not my department’.	MAJOR
CS-RULE-013	Agent must adapt tone to the customer’s emotional state. Agent must never match an elevated customer’s volume. Speak at a lower pitch and slower pace for angry customers.	MAJOR

2.5 Back-Office Tickets

The single-tier model resolves issues at the agent’s seat. When an issue cannot be closed on the call (because it requires offline systems, specialist teams, or out-of-policy approval), the agent opens a ticket to the relevant back-office team and tells the customer the expected follow-up timeline. The agent never transfers the call.

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-014	When a ticket is required, agent must (a) inform the customer in plain language, (b) state the team handling the ticket, (c) state the expected follow-up window, and (d) provide the case reference number before closing the call.	MAJOR
CS-RULE-015	Standard follow-up SLAs: Network Operations (outage/infrastructure) = 2 hours. Revenue Assurance (billing dispute > authority) = 4 hours. Data Compliance (suspected unauthorized access) = within 72 hours. Manager Review (credit > authority, ETF waiver) = 1 business day.	MAJOR

2.6 Abuse & Harassment

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-016	Personal attacks, slurs, sexual harassment, or physical threats trigger the 3-Strike Protocol. Strike 1: warning. Strike 2: final warning. Strike 3: call termination with stated reason. Swearing at the situation is not abuse; swearing at the agent is. After termination, agent must flag the account in CRM and log a Customer Conduct case note.	MAJOR
CS-RULE-017	If a customer threatens self-harm or harm to others, agent must keep the line open (mute), follow the on-screen Safety Protocol prompt, and contact emergency services per local procedure. Do not disconnect.	CRITICAL

2.7 Resolution & Closing

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-018	Before closing, agent must explain the root cause of the issue to the customer.	MAJOR
CS-RULE-019	Agent must deliver a resolution summary in the format: Issue + Fix + Follow-Up Actions, before closing.	MAJOR
CS-RULE-020	Agent must ask ‘Is there anything else I can help you with today?’ before closing every call.	MAJOR
CS-RULE-021	Agent must provide the Case Reference Number and offer the post-call survey. Exception: do not offer survey if the call ended in a completed cancellation.	MAJOR

2.8 Documentation

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-022	Case notes must be completed and saved within 5 minutes of call end. Required fields: verification	MAJOR

ID	Rule	Severity
CS-RULE-023	method, issue reported, troubleshooting steps taken, resolution status, customer sentiment, ticket numbers raised. Case notes must never contain full card numbers, full SSN, PINs, passwords, or security answers. Mask all sensitive identifiers.	CRITICAL